

Ecclesiastical Latin

EL-II.5: Subjunctive Morphology and Sequence of Tenses

Form the four ordinary subjunctive tenses and separate morphological identification, sequence, relative time, and syntactic use

A self-contained learning packet with a local reference card, enriched submodules, selected handwritten practice, a mastery record, and matching answers. This working study is not an official liturgical book or approved curriculum.

Corpus	1962 <i>Missale Romanum</i> ; Vulgate and ecclesiastical prose as supporting readers
Method	Print, annotate, parse, copy, transform, translate, and compose by hand
Pacing	Advance by demonstrated mastery; module packets use two focused sessions as a planning envelope
Document	Learning module; learner and terminal-key edition
Triptych: AI Driven Studies in Catholic Faith, Worship, and Law	

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Part I

Module Plan and Reference

CHAPTER 1

Plan, prerequisites, and advancement decision

Module ID	EL-II.5
Course stage	Stage II — Core Grammar
Prerequisites	EL-II.4 mastery: attach participles and preserve agency and relative time
Observable outcome	Form the four ordinary subjunctive tenses and separate morphological identification, sequence, relative time, and syntactic use
Printed practice	Worksheets II.17 (guided Variant A) and II.20 (independent Variant D), with terminal keys
Extension bank	Worksheets II.18 and II.19 remain optional remediation or delayed-recall variants
Next dependency	EL-II.6, Purpose, Result, and Indirect Command

1.1 Two focused sessions

Session 1 — guided acquisition. Use the morphology-before-use flowchart to form active and passive subjunctives and *sum*, then complete Worksheet II.17 as the guided application.

Session 2 — transfer and gate. Map primary/historic sequence and same/prior time, classify contextual uses only after forms are secure, and complete Worksheet II.20 independently.

The two-session plan is a workload envelope, not permission to advance by elapsed time. Stop, correct in a different color, and use an omitted variant when the mastery evidence below is absent.

Advance when: Produce at least 44 of 48 prompted subjunctive forms within the stated interval, classify primary/historic and same/prior time correctly in all ten clauses, and explain both tense and use in an unseen passage.

CHAPTER 2

Module reference card

2.1 Terms, forms, and decisions to retrieve

- present, imperfect, perfect, and pluperfect active and passive subjunctive formation;
- the corresponding subjunctives of *sum*;
- primary versus historic sequence and same/subsequent versus prior time; and
- morphology, sequence, time relation, and clause use as separate decisions.

2.2 High-risk contrast

A form can be identified as subjunctive before its clause use is known. Sequence relates dependent tense to the governing context; it does not by itself name purpose, result, command, or another construction.

2.3 Working protocol

Before looking anything up, mark the finite verb or verbal center, propose dictionary forms, and record at least two formally possible readings where an ending is syncretic. Use the identified 1962 Missal and the course source record for received wording. A familiar English rendering does not replace a parse.

Part II

Core Lesson

CHAPTER 1

Subjunctive morphology and sequence of tenses

On completing this unit, you can:

- form every active and passive subjunctive of a regular verb and *sum*;
- explain the time relation expressed by each subjunctive tense;
- apply primary and historic sequence in dependent clauses;
- distinguish a morphological identification from a clause's syntactic use.

1.1 The four tenses

The **subjunctive mood** presents an action through the speaker's or sentence's framing—for example as wished, commanded, purposed, resulting, possible, or dependent in reported thought. The **indicative** ordinarily asserts or asks about an action as a fact. Mood is a property of the verb form; the clause type explains why that mood is used in context.

When a subjunctive stands independently, a **jussive** expresses a third-person command, a **hortatory** urges first-person plural action, and an **optative** expresses a wish. In dependent clauses, the conjunction and the clause's function determine its use. These independent uses return in the unit on commands and wishes.

Present and imperfect subjunctive

The present subjunctive uses the tense signs *-e-* in the first conjugation and *-a-* in the others, followed by personal endings:

<i>amare</i>	<i>monere</i>	<i>regere</i>	<i>capere</i>	<i>audire</i>	<i>esse</i>
amem	moneam	regam	capiam	audiam	sim
ames	moneas	regas	capias	audias	sis
amet	moneat	regat	capiat	audiat	sit
amemus	moneamus	regamus	capiamus	audiamus	simus
ametis	moneatis	regatis	capiatis	audiatis	sitis
ament	moneant	regant	capiant	audiant	sint

The imperfect adds personal endings directly to the present active infinitive: *amarem, amares, amaret, amaremus, amaretis, amarent; essem, esses, esset, essemus, essetis, essent*. Passive forms replace active endings with *-r, -ris/-re, -tur, -mur, -mini, -ntur*: *amer, ameris, ametur; amarer, amareris, amaretur*. Deponents use passive morphology with active meaning.

Perfect and pluperfect subjunctive

The perfect active is perfect stem + *-eri-* + personal endings: *amaverim, amaveris, amaverit, amaverimus, amaveritis, amaverint*. The pluperfect active is the perfect active infinitive + personal endings: *amavissem, amavisses, amavisset, amavissemus, amavissetis, amavissent*.

Perfect passive is perfect passive participle + present subjunctive of *sum*: *amatus sim*; pluperfect passive uses imperfect subjunctive: *amatus essem*. The participle always agrees with the subject: *hostiæ oblatæ sint; dona benedicta essent*.

Beware identical-looking forms. *amaverit* can be perfect subjunctive or future perfect indicative; *amaverimus* can be perfect subjunctive or future perfect indicative. Clause environment, not appearance alone, decides.

1.2 Sequence of tenses

Sequence of tenses is the conventional matching of a dependent subjunctive's tense to the time of its governing verb and to whether the dependent action is simultaneous/subsequent or prior. **Primary sequence** uses a present or future viewpoint; **historic sequence** uses a past viewpoint. Sequence locates the dependent action; it does not name the clause's purpose or meaning.

The sequence table

Governing verb	Same or subsequent dependent action	Prior dependent action
Primary: present, future, future perfect, or perfect with present force	present subjunctive	perfect subjunctive
Historic: imperfect, historical perfect, or pluperfect	imperfect subjunctive	pluperfect subjunctive

Sequence locates dependent action relative to the governing action. It does not itself tell why the subjunctive is used. First label the clause—purpose, result, indirect command, question, *cum*, and so forth—then state sequence. Writers may use primary sequence after a historical present, preserve a perfect for a completed result, or use a tense required by an independent condition. Those are meaningful choices, not permission to ignore the table.

1.3 Reading the forms in context

Worked example: present sequence at the Orate fratres

Worked passage ID: W.II.17; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Orate, fratres, ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem.

Analysis. *Fiat* is third-person singular present subjunctive of *fiō*; it follows the present-time imperative *orate* and expresses action subsequent to the prayer. Morphology is present; the English sense is “may become/be made.”

Translation. “Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable before God, the almighty Father.”

Worked example: anterior action within the Canon

Worked passage ID: W.II.18; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Ut quotquot ex hac altaris participatione sacrosanctum Filii tui Corpus et Sanguinem sumpserimus, omni benedictione cælesti et gratia repleamur.

Analysis. Perfect subjunctive *sumpserimus* is prior to present subjunctive *repleamur*. The latter is first-person plural present passive. The sequence asks that all of us who have received may then be filled.

Translation. “That all of us who have received the most holy Body and Blood of your Son from this sharing in the altar may be filled with every heavenly blessing and grace.”

Worked example: historic sequence before the Passion

Worked passage ID: W.II.19; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Qui pridie quam pateretur, accepit panem.

Analysis. *Pateretur* is third-person singular imperfect subjunctive of the deponent *patior*. With historic *accepit*, *pridie quam* places the anticipated suffering after the taking of bread.

Translation. “Who, on the day before he was to suffer, took bread.”

Worked example: historic indirect command (Mark 5:10)

Worked passage ID: W.II.20; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Et deprecabatur eum multum, ne se expelleret extra regionem.

Analysis. Imperfect *deprecabatur* governs an indirect command. Imperfect subjunctive *expelleret* is same/subsequent in historic sequence; *se* is its accusative object and refers to the speaker.

Translation. “And he earnestly begged him not to drive him out of the region.”

1.4 Writing laboratory

Write from memory the present active table for all five conjugations and *sum*. Beneath each form write its passive counterpart. Then produce all four subjunctive tenses of *benedico* in third-person singular and plural, active and passive.

Build two time diagrams. Under *rogat*, place *veniat* and *venerit*; under *rogavit*, place *veniret* and *venisset*. Compose one Latin sentence for each diagram and explain its relative time in English.

Advance when: you produce 44 of 48 prompted subjunctive forms correctly in twelve minutes, classify primary/historic and same/prior time correctly in ten of ten clauses, and explain the use as well as the tense of every subjunctive in an unseen six-line passage.

Part III

Enrichment by Submodule

CHAPTER 1

Connections, transfer, and retrieval

1.1 The four tenses — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A morphology-before-use flowchart prevents a familiar translation from assigning a construction prematurely.

Transfer task. For twelve lesson forms, follow four boxes: identify stem and markers, state person/number/tense/voice/mood, list any formal ambiguity, and only then open the clause context.

Retrieval check. Recite the formation cue for each of the four ordinary subjunctive tenses.

1.2 Sequence of tenses — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A two-axis chart separates governing sequence from the dependent action's relative time.

Transfer task. Place primary and historic governing verbs on one axis and same/subsequent and prior dependent time on the other. Fill the four lesson tense choices and add one project-composed English scenario to each cell without composing new Latin.

Retrieval check. State which dependent tenses ordinarily fill the four cells.

1.3 Reading the forms in context — enrichment and transfer

Connection. Only after morphology and sequence are fixed can governor and signal support a use label.

Transfer task. For each subjunctive in one lesson reading, write a four-line dossier: full parse, governing word, connective or signal, and narrowest defensible use. Add any genuine ambiguity instead of forcing one label.

Retrieval check. Explain why *ut* plus subjunctive is not enough evidence by itself for purpose.

1.4 Writing laboratory — enrichment and transfer

Connection. A time diagram tests sequence while keeping syntactic use constant.

Transfer task. Use the lesson's *rogat/rogavit* diagrams. Replace only the governing time and select the dependent tense that preserves same or prior relation; label the relation before checking the model.

Retrieval check. State what changed and what stayed constant in each pair.

Part IV

Selected Practice

CHAPTER 1

Subjunctive forms and sequence: parallel forms

V2.5A — Subjunctive A**Worksheet ID:** II.17**Focus:** four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence**Use:** Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give the present active subjunctive of *amo*.

2. Give third singular and plural, all four active subjunctive tenses of *benedico*.

3. Choose by sequence:

Rogat ut ille (venire) _____; rogavit ut ille (venire) _____.

4. Choose prior action: *Scit quid (facere) _____; sciebat quid (facere) _____.*

5. **Text:** *Orate, fratres, ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem.*

Passage ID: II.17.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *fiat* and explain sequence.

6. Write in Latin: “He asks that the gifts be blessed; he asked that they be blessed.”

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

V2.5D — Subjunctive D**Worksheet ID:** II.20**Focus:** four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence**Use:** Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give third singular and plural present subjunctive of all five model conjugations.

2. Give the four third-plural passive subjunctives of *offero*.

3. Complete the sequence grid for *dicit/dixit* + same action and prior action.

4. Parse *sint* in *ut dona sancta sint* and *sunto* in a rubric.

5. **Text:** *Et deprecabatur eum multum, ne se expelleret extra regionem.*

*Passage ID: II.20.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.*Parse both verbs and explain reference of *se*.

6. Write a primary and historic pair meaning “He asks/asked that what was offered be received.”

Definition/error check: First define uncertain Focus terms from memory; after the work, record each correction’s rule.

Part V**Mastery Decision****CHAPTER 1**

Mastery and error record

Complete this page before opening the answer part.

Evidence	Session 1	Session 2 / delayed check
Date and elapsed focused time		
Worksheet ID and score		
One rule retrieved without notes		
One recurring error family		
Correction stated as a rule		
Unseen or delayed item used		

Advance / remediate decision: _____ **Next review date:**

Reason in one complete sentence:

Part VI

Answer Key

CHAPTER 1

How to Use the Keys

These keys diagnose grammatical decisions. Compare them only after completing the corresponding worksheet or assessment in ink. For a closed item, locate the form, function, government, or clause relation that decides the answer; a matching English paraphrase alone is not enough. For an open task, use the stated model and rubric to test morphology, syntax, idiom, and source control.

Some translations legitimately admit more than one English wording. An alternative is acceptable when it preserves the Latin agency, negation, time, dependency, and material ambiguity. Record a defensible alternative in the error ledger rather than changing it merely to imitate the model's style.

CHAPTER 2

Enrichment models and rubrics

The four tenses — model and rubric

Connection. A morphology-before-use flowchart prevents a familiar translation from assigning a construction prematurely.

Model / acceptable evidence. The forms must be generated by the lesson's present-subjunctive markers, present infinitive plus endings for imperfect, perfect-stem formation for perfect, and perfect infinitive plus endings for pluperfect, with passive formations preserved. No clause-use label belongs before morphology is complete.

Sequence of tenses — model and rubric

Connection. A two-axis chart separates governing sequence from the dependent action's relative time.

Model / acceptable evidence. Primary plus same/subsequent ordinarily uses present subjunctive; primary plus prior uses perfect; historic plus same/subsequent uses imperfect; historic plus prior uses pluperfect. The scenario must preserve those time relations.

Reading the forms in context — model and rubric

Connection. Only after morphology and sequence are fixed can governor and signal support a use label.

Model / acceptable evidence. The dossier must consider the governing expression, internal markers, negation, sequence, and discourse force. *ut* introduces several clause families, so subjunctive mood and connective alone do not distinguish them.

Writing laboratory — model and rubric

Connection. A time diagram tests sequence while keeping syntactic use constant.

Model / acceptable evidence. The governing sequence and dependent tense change together, while the intended relative-time relation and clause dependency remain constant. Correct pairs follow the four-cell sequence chart rather than an English tense imitation.

CHAPTER 3

Selected worksheet solutions

CHAPTER 4

Subjunctive forms and sequence: parallel forms

V2.5A — Subjunctive A

Worksheet ID: II.17

Focus: four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence

Use: Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give the present active subjunctive of *amo*.

Answer / model: *amem, ames, amet, amemus, ametis, ament*.

2. Give third singular and plural, all four active subjunctive tenses of *benedico*.

Answer / model: *benedicat/benedicant; benediceret/benedicerent; benedixerit/benedixerint; benedixisset/benedixissent*.

3. Choose by sequence:

Rogat ut ille (venire) _____; rogavit ut ille (venire) _____.

Answer / model: *veniat; veniret*. Both are same/subsequent; the first follows primary, the second historic sequence.

4. Choose prior action: *Scit quid (facere) _____; sciebat quid (facere) _____.*

Answer / model: *fecerit; fecisset*. Perfect follows primary, pluperfect historic.

5. **Text:** *Orate, fratres, ut meum ac vestrum sacrificium acceptabile fiat apud Deum Patrem omnipotentem.*

Passage ID: II.17.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.

Parse *fiat* and explain sequence.

Answer / notes: Third singular present subjunctive of *fiō*, subsequent to the primary-time imperative *orate*. “Pray, brethren, that my sacrifice and yours may be acceptable before God, the almighty Father.”

6. Write in Latin: “He asks that the gifts be blessed; he asked that they be blessed.”

Answer / model: *Rogat ut dona benedicantur; rogavit ut dona benedicerentur*. Present and imperfect passive follow their respective sequences.

V2.5D — Subjunctive D

Worksheet ID: II.20

Focus: four tenses, active/passive, primary and historic sequence

Use: Parse morphology before naming clause use.

1. Give third singular and plural present subjunctive of all five model conjugations.
Answer / model: *amet/ament, moneat/moneant, regat/regant, capiat/capiant, audiat/audiant.*
2. Give the four third-plural passive subjunctives of *offero*.
Answer / model: *offerantur, offerrentur, oblati sint, oblati essent*; for neuter gifts, *oblata sint/essent*.
3. Complete the sequence grid for *dicit/dixit* + same action and prior action.
Answer / model: Primary: present subjunctive for same/subsequent, perfect for prior. Historic: imperfect for same/subsequent, pluperfect for prior.
4. Parse *sint* in *ut dona sancta sint* and *sunto* in a rubric.
Answer / model: *Sint*: third plural present subjunctive of *sum*; *sunto*: third plural future imperative, “they shall be.”
5. **Text:** *Et deprecabatur eum multum, ne se expelleret extra regionem.*
Passage ID: II.20.1; exact source and collation state are recorded in the passage inventory.
Parse both verbs and explain reference of *se*.
Answer / notes: *Deprecabatur*: third singular imperfect indicative deponent; *expelleret*: third singular imperfect active subjunctive in historic sequence. *Se* refers to the one begging. “He earnestly begged him not to drive him out of the region.”
6. Write a primary and historic pair meaning “He asks/asked that what was offered be received.”
Answer / model: *Rogat ut quod oblatum sit accipiat; rogavit ut quod oblatum esset acciperetur.*

Part VII

Scope and Sources

CHAPTER 1

Scope and Qualifications

1.1 Packet boundary

This is module EL-II.5, *Subjunctive Morphology and Sequence of Tenses*, in Triptych's print-first Ecclesiastical Latin curriculum. It imports one authoritative teaching unit, its local reference decisions, enrichment for each internal submodule, the selected worksheets named in the module plan, and the matching solutions. This packet establishes form and sequence; the following modules classify the major syntactic uses.

The unprinted worksheet variants remain course-owned extension material; their omission is intentional and is not a claim that the module exhausts available practice. Two focused sessions describe the packet's planned core, while the mastery gate and delayed recall determine advancement.

1.2 Corpus, text, and limits

The controlling reader is the 1962 typical edition of the *Missale Romanum*; the identified Clementine Vulgate and other ecclesiastical prose are supporting corpora. Running Latin normally uses consonantal *i*, the ligature *æ*, and no macrons. Received excerpts may normalize typography but are not diplomatic transcriptions unless labeled. Uncited short drills, transformations, and instructional models are project-composed; English translations and glosses are project translations unless identified otherwise.

This packet teaches language competence. It is not an official liturgical book, approved seminary curriculum, certification, pronunciation or ceremonial course, critical edition, or authority for a liturgical, theological, textual, or canonical judgment. Check received wording against the editions identified in the course-wide passage inventory.

1.3 Review, rights, and release state

Course-wide research records own the edition, passage, answer, curriculum, and source decisions; the leaf's module map records this packet's selection and enrichment. No independent Latinist, liturgist, pedagogue, theologian, or ecclesiastical reviewer is claimed. Page-image collation and the donor and liturgical-text distribution bases remain unresolved pre-installation gates. The packet therefore remains a working build on hold, not an installed or released publication.

CHAPTER 2

References

The following works are the course's controlling corpus and reference aids. Project-composed explanation, translation, analysis, exercises, and models are distinguished from received wording under the convention stated in the Scope and Qualifications appendix. Short source passages are identified so that the learner can verify their wider context. The adjacent edition manifest and passage inventory record exact source roles, checks, access states, and known rights limits.

2.1 Primary corpus

- Catholic Church, *Missale Romanum ex decreto SS. Concilii Tridentini restitutum, Summorum Pontificum cura recognitum*, editio typica (Rome, 1962). A searchable presentation of the edition is hosted by the Holy See's Biblia Clerus project: <https://www.clerus.org/bibliaclerusonline/EN/gmb.htm>.
- A page-image scan of the 1962 typical edition is available through the Church Music Association of America: <https://media.churchmusicassociation.org/pdf/missale62.pdf>. Page images, rather than unsourced transcriptions, should decide doubtful punctuation or spelling.
- The Clementine Vulgate is the principal biblical comparison corpus. The public-domain 1914 edition edited by Michael Hetzenauer and its provenance are described at <https://www.sacredbible.org/vulgate1914/>.

2.2 Grammar and lexicography

- J. H. Allen and J. B. Greenough, *New Latin Grammar for Schools and Colleges* (1903), a donor-declared public-domain reference whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <https://archive.org/details/allengreenoughsn01alle>.
- Charles E. Bennett, *New Latin Grammar*, 1918 revision, Project Gutenberg eBook 15665; public-domain text in the United States: <https://www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/15665>.
- Charlton T. Lewis and Charles Short, *A Latin Dictionary* (1879), searchable transcription: <https://logeion.uchicago.edu/lexidium>.
- Charles du Fresne, sieur du Cange, *Glossarium mediae et infimae latinitatis*, a donor-declared later-vocabulary aid whose digital locator was not independently consulted during integration: <http://ducange.enc.sorbonne.fr/>.

The underlying 1903, 1918, 1879, and 1883–1887 printed works are public domain in the United States. Digital transcriptions and interfaces retain their own terms and are cited as access tools, not relicensed or reproduced wholesale. The 1962 Missal, Scripture, official text, and other received wording retain their own status; see the scope appendix, research records, and final-page rights notice.

Classical reference grammars describe the inherited system but do not by themselves explain every biblical or ecclesiastical development. The advanced volume therefore distinguishes classical baseline, Vulgate usage, later Christian usage, and stable liturgical formula instead of labeling every difference an “exception.”

2.3 Citation convention

Missal passages are cited by liturgical location and text genre rather than by a page number that varies among printings. Biblical texts are cited by book, chapter, and verse. Historical authors are cited by work and section wherever possible. A learner preparing a formal commentary should verify each passage against the edition actually being used and record any variant. These references are not a claim that every historical-linguistic question can be settled by the listed school grammars and dictionary interfaces.

CHAPTER 3

Generation Metadata

Last revised (UTC): 2026-07-20T21:32:44Z

Model: GPT-5-based Codex agent; unexposed: exact model identifier and model qualifiers

Agent/runtime: OpenAI Codex agents (curriculum architecture, module design, enrichment, source and answer audit, correction, production, and review); Codex CLI 0.144.6; API workspace; unexposed: server revision

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